



Oral Cancer Surgery

Purpose: Surgical removal of malignant tumors from the mouth, tongue, jaw, or surrounding tissues, often followed by reconstruction.

First 24–72 Hours:

- Swelling, bruising, and discomfort are common.
- Apply ice packs for the first 24 hours to reduce swelling.
- Keep the head elevated to minimize swelling.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Take prescribed pain medications and antibiotics exactly as directed.
- Numbness or changes in speech/swallowing may occur, depending on surgical site.

Oral Hygiene:

- Follow your surgeon's instructions for gentle cleaning of the surgical area.
- Use prescribed antimicrobial rinses to reduce infection risk.

Diet:

- Soft or liquid diet as recommended, possibly requiring a feeding tube in extensive surgeries.
- Avoid hot, spicy, or acidic foods that may irritate the site.

Special Precautions:

- Avoid smoking and alcohol, as they delay healing and increase cancer recurrence risk.
- Speech or swallowing therapy may be needed as part of recovery.

Follow-Up:

- Multiple follow-up visits will be scheduled to monitor healing and check for recurrence.
- Contact your surgeon immediately if you notice persistent bleeding, swelling after 3 days, fever, or difficulty breathing.